

Retainer Business

Business Goals

- Foster long-term advisory, trusted relationship
- Avoid single-engagement clients as too costly from a cost of sales
- Avoid the “write a Profile” as only briefing solution
- Create an entry vehicle for more and ongoing consulting services

Current Products

- \$17,500 two-day retainer
- \$11,000 one-day “emerging company” starter
- [eBusiness@Aberdeen](#) Alschuler surveys
- Hurley security retainers

Sales Issues with Current Retainers

- Analyst trust comes before sale can close
- Cost/value seen as low early in client relationship
- Long-term services when short-term budget need may exist
- Spotty client satisfaction leads to spotty renewals: execution quality

Entry Retainer Concept

- Services base without any add-on analyst days
- Cost at \$500 a month, billable quarterly (\$6,000 annual)
- Creates a low-cost entrée to Aberdeen “club”
- Basis for many other bundled service offerings

Aberdeen Advisory Access Service

- Assigned, 1:1 analyst access
 - Quarterly telephone briefings
 - Ad hoc telephone consultation
- Press and investor quotes by neutral party
- Annual briefing review & analysis
- Access to pod publications online
- Preferred (e.g., add-on, not initial) per diem rates
- Newsletter (I.e., ETI and/or marketing)

AAAS Value Proposition

- Ad hoc, same-business-day access to Aberdeen analyst and Aberdeen's analysis
 - Market dynamics
 - Competitive moves
 - M&A event impact
 - Position or message ideas
- Prompt, informed answers to “What if”, “Why” and “Do you think” questions

How to Buy AAAS

- Standalone – low cost advisory relationship door-opener
- Bundled – incremental service offering that adds continuity to a one-off engagement
 - Consulting workshop
 - Publication
 - Content pubs subscription
- Becomes an add-on to many task-specific proposals (as is the case today)

Selling AAAS

- Not a winning cold-call, standalone product
 - Same resistance as now: “I don’t know or trust you guys enough to commit to a one-year retainer.”
 - Not enough services to open eyes possible at \$6,000 price point
- Becomes an added-revenue kicker component *after* we have done some other work for the client
 - Follow-on to a Profile project